

Lydia Wildes Schnurpel

lydiawildes1@gmail.com

Website: <https://lgwildes.github.io/portfolio-2026>

About Me

Four years ago I quit teaching middle school theatre and joined a full-time software engineering bootcamp. For over three years I've been working as a front end developer at a Drupal agency. My years as a teacher taught me how to collaborate with diverse groups of people and find creative solutions under stress. My years as a theatre kid taught me how to burst into spontaneous showtunes and say "Yes AND..."

Skills & Tools

- Drupal
- Wordpress
- Git
- Documentation
- Architecture
- Pantheon
- JavaScript
- React

Additional Skills

- Efficiency & Optimization
- Effective Communication
- Attention to Detail
- Conflict Resolution
- Leadership
- Organization
- Time Management
- Remote Work

Experience

Gravity Works Design & Development

Front End Developer

February 2023 - Present

- Plan, document, and develop Drupal and Wordpress sites
- Maintain existing sites (DNN, Wordpress, and Drupal 7 through Drupal 11)
- Assist on other teams' projects to ensure timely delivery
- Learn new CSS and Javascript skills and take courses for professional development
- Attend conferences and document findings for the front end team

Prime Digital Academy

Full Stack Software Engineer Student

August 2022 - January 2023

Solo Project: *Where to Next?*

Developed a full stack React application for clients to search for vacation destinations based on various preferences.

Technologies include: CSS, HTML, Material UI, React.js, Redux.js, JavaScript, Express, Node.js, SQL, Postgres

Group Client Project: *ILT Academy learning management system and community portal*

Technologies include: HTML, Material UI, React.js, Redux.js, JavaScript, Express, Node.js, SQL, Postgres, Google Calendar API, AWS S3, SunEditor

Client: Nick Tietz, ILT Academy

Minnehaha Academy

Middle School Teacher

November 2017 - June 2022

- Taught diverse groups of students.
- Differentiated instruction based on individual student needs.
- Supported students in crisis ensuring they felt safe and able to learn.
- Managed and de-escalated conflict.
- Aligned coursework to meet and support state standards.
- Created assessments to track and encourage student learning.
- Coordinated with administrators and vendors to schedule and host school-wide events.

Leadership Roles:

- Director of Minnehaha Middle School Leadership Institute
- Advisor to the Student Council
- Advisor to the Yearbook Committee

Courses Taught:

- 7th grade technology (typing, coding, 3D design, digital citizenship)
- 8th grade technology (Google Drive, Canva, Pixelmator, Garageband, iMovie)
- 8th grade theater (history, improvisation, performance, devising, Shakespeare, analysis)

Middle School Theatre Director

November 2017 - June 2022

- Delegated work to supporting staff and volunteers.
- Assessed student strengths and encouraged participation in a variety of roles.
- Scheduled rehearsals to honor participants' time.
- Revamped and expanded theatre season.
- Coordinating and managing vendor relationships.
- Acquired funding for and spearheaded theater stage remodel.

Education

Prime Digital Academy

Full Stack Software Engineering Certification

August 2022 - January 2023

Training included: public speaking and presentation practice, professional skill development, diversity, equity, and inclusion, real-world client work.

Southern Arkansas University

M.A. Teaching

June 2021 - July 2022

University of Northwestern St. Paul

B.A. Theatre Arts, B.A. Biblical Studies

August 2013 - December 2016